

SE02 CREATE BUSINESS CONTINUITY PLAN | O (MAX: 1 PT)

Intent: Prepare organizations to operate, to the extent possible, under disruptive circumstances.

Summary: This feature requires projects to create a business continuity plan to facilitate resilience during and recovery after an emergency.

Issue: Globally, the frequency, size and cost of disasters is increasing due to climate change, population growth and rapid urbanization.^{62–64} In 2019, the global economic losses from disasters amounted to \$232 billion, and the 2020 COVID-19 pandemic caused the largest global recession in history.^{62,65} Small businesses may be particularly vulnerable as research shows that about 90% of smaller companies fail after emergencies unless they can resume business operations within five days.^{66,67} Emergencies such as biological events or active shooters may necessitate sheltering in the workplace, while longer-term emergencies may lead to extended workplace shutdowns.^{68–75} The latter can result in extensive layoffs, while employees who continue working may be forced to work in high-risk conditions or remotely in spaces not equipped to support productivity.^{71–75} Most individuals who go through emergencies experience psychological distress, resulting in depression, anxiety, feelings of hopelessness, fatigue, irritability or anger.^{76,77} These impacts can be exacerbated by added stressors during emergencies such as social isolation, domestic abuse, economic hardship or loss of loved ones.^{76,77}

Solutions: Business continuity planning is critical to help manage business disruption, restore business operations, minimize risk to employees and mitigate financial loss when emergencies occur.^{59,60,78,79} Establishing organizational remote work readiness can help operations run smoothly and support employee well-being and productivity when an emergency makes remote work imperative.^{78,80}

Part 1 Part 1 (Max: 1 Pt)

For All Spaces:

Projects implement a business continuity plan (BCP) that addresses at minimum the following:

- a. Determines critical business functions, processes, supporting resources and dependencies (e.g., email, internet connectivity, third-party suppliers or service providers, interdependent departments).
- b. Includes a list of the roles and responsibilities of the business continuity team and convenes the team annually (at minimum) to review, test and update (as needed) the plan.
- c. Implements a business impact analysis to evaluate the likely effects resulting from disruption of normal business functioning due to a disaster and identifies which critical business functions should be prioritized for recovery.
- d. Conducts a remote work readiness assessment, including at minimum the following:
 1. Evaluates which employees and/or positions (if any) are able to work remotely.
 2. Evaluates which employees and/or positions (if any) have the necessary support infrastructure to work productively in a remote situation.
 3. Evaluates whether organizational technology (e.g., company laptops, virtual private network (VPN)) is set up to support enterprise-wide remote work.
 4. Implements the strategies necessary to support remote work readiness as determined by the evaluation, including (as applicable) methods of communication to employees during remote work and provision for alternate work locations.
- e. Outlines strategies to support short- and long-term continuity in various disasters (e.g., blizzard, pandemic), restore and maintain business operations following disruption and re-mobilize to address recurring disasters.

Note: This feature is a beta strategy and has an additional documentation requirement (beta feature feedback form). The feedback form supports IWBI in developing new features that are effective and applicable to projects around the world.